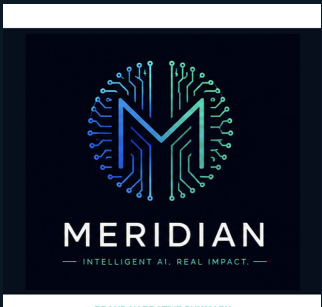




Products and Pricing

The Go-to-Market Set

Built on the confirmed definition: Meridian is an executive intelligence practice
Its product is the decision brief · 5 August 2026

PRIVATE AND CONFIDENTIAL

THE PRICING LOGIC — SAY THIS BEFORE ANY NUMBER

Meridian is not priced on time. It is priced on **the consequence of the decision it is answering.**

The rule: the fee sits roughly two orders of magnitude below the value of the decision.
A €500,000 decision earns a €5,000 brief. A €5m transaction earns a €20,000 one.

This is the sentence that does the selling, and the sentence that stops the conversation becoming a day-rate negotiation. If a client is weighing whether to spend €4,500, the honest answer is that their decision is probably not big enough for Meridian yet, and saying so builds more trust than discounting.

The comparison that makes it obvious. A mid-tier consultancy strategic review is €40,000 to €100,000 and takes six to twelve weeks. Meridian delivers a comparable depth of multi-domain analysis in days, at a fraction of that, because the analysis is produced by a governed engine and the senior time goes into judgment and verification rather than production.

THE PRODUCT LADDER

Five products. Four sell today. One is the long game.

#	Product	What it answers	Scope	Turnaround	Founding	List
1	Decision Brief	One specific question	Up to 3 domains	5 working days	€3,750	€4,950
2	Executive Intelligence Review	A whole situation, every angle	All 7 domains	10 working days	€9,750	€12,950
3	Transaction Intelligence	Should we do this deal, on what terms	All 7, deal-grade	10 to 15 days	€15,000	€19,500
4	Intelligence Partner (retained)	Everything, continuously	See tiers	Standing	from €2,750/mth	from €3,750/mth

#	Product	What it answers	Scope	Turnaround	Founding	List
5	AI Equity Structuring	AI capability for equity	Bespoke	Bespoke	Fee + equity	Fee + equity

Founding rate applies to the first ten clients and ends 31 December 2026. This replaces the current “friends rate.” Same discount, better strategy: a founding rate has a reason and an end date, so it can be withdrawn without insulting anyone. A friends rate never can, and it quietly tells the market your list price is decoration.

1 DECISION BRIEF — €3,750 FOUNDING / €4,950 LIST

One decision. Five days. A written position you can take to your board.

What it answers. A single, specific, high-consequence question with a yes or no at the end of it.

Already delivered in this shape: Should United Hardware buy a standalone garden centre? Should Stargas enter cylinder testing? What instrument should Barber Republic take Ed Lawton's £50,000 on?

What the client gets

- A structured written brief, typically 8 to 15 pages, branded and print-ready
- A clear recommendation with the reasoning attached
- The three to five risks that would change the answer
- Every claim labelled verified, estimated or unverified
- The questions the client should be able to answer before committing
- A 45-minute call to walk it through

Scope boundary. One decision. Up to three of the seven domains. One round of clarification. Additional domains at €1,250 each.

***Why it is priced here.** At under €5,000 it sits inside a managing director's own signing authority, which means it does not need a board paper to buy. That is deliberate, and it is the single most important commercial property of this product.*

2 EXECUTIVE INTELLIGENCE REVIEW — €9,750 FOUNDING / €12,950 LIST

Your whole situation, interrogated from seven senior angles at once, in ten days.

What it answers. Not one question but a position. Where is this business exposed, where is value being left on the table, and what should the board do about it.

Already delivered in this shape: the Arcade Trader four-domain consolidated report with growth model and value-building analysis. The Fleming Medical seven-domain investigative analysis, which corrected an earlier optimistic scoring, found value concentrated in three obscured segments, and closed with the five questions the board had to answer before any capital event.

What the client gets

- All seven domains interrogated, eight to ten specific questions each
- A consolidated executive intelligence brief with a synthesised position
- The five key risks, ranked
- A programme of recommended actions with sequencing
- The human gate: the questions the board must be able to answer before committing
- A 90-minute presentation to the client's board or leadership team

Scope boundary. One business or one division. Ten working days from full information. Follow-on work quoted separately.

***Why it is priced here.** This is the flagship and the reference product. At €12,950 list it is roughly a quarter of what a mid-tier firm charges for less, delivered in a sixth of the time.*

3 TRANSACTION INTELLIGENCE — €15,000 FOUNDING / €19,500 LIST

Due-diligence-grade analysis before you sign, structured the way the other side's adviser will attack it.

What it answers. Should we do this deal, at what value, on what instrument, and what will we regret in eighteen months.

Already delivered in this shape: the Barber Republic funding structure work. A funding ladder across bridge, pre-seed, seed and Series 1 to 3, dilution modelled across rounds, two investor scenarios, instrument recommendation and investor protections, plus a rollout funding roadmap. It converged independently with the founder's own separately written documents, which is what gave the recommendation its authority in the room.

What the client gets

- Everything in the Executive Intelligence Review, applied to the transaction
- Valuation and dilution modelling across the funding or exit path
- Instrument analysis and recommendation, with the alternatives and why they were rejected
- Term-by-term negotiating position, including what to concede and what not to
- Counterparty read: what the other side will push for and how to answer it
- Standing availability through the negotiation window

Why it is priced here. A corporate finance adviser on the same transaction charges a retainer plus a success fee running to multiples of this. Meridian is not replacing that adviser. It is making sure the client walks into the room already knowing their position.

Optional success element. On transactions above €2m, consider a reduced fee plus a success element of 0.5 to 1 per cent on completion. Offer it, do not lead with it. It signals confidence and it materially raises the ceiling on this product.

4 INTELLIGENCE PARTNER — RETAINED

A standing seat at your board's decision-making, not a project.

Already delivered in this shape: United Hardware. Paint buying group validation, verification pack, location addendum, a formal response to a reviewer's challenge, the garden centre question, the 2025 audit review, a Data Transformation board paper and a Vendor Challenge Brief. Multiple decisions, one board, standing access. **It has been a retained relationship in everything but name and price.**

Tier	Who it is for	Included	Founding	List
Board Seat	A board wanting the discipline available	1 Decision Brief per quarter, standing availability	€2,750/mth	€3,750/mth
Intelligence Partner	An active board or a founder in a growth phase	1 Decision Brief per month, 1 Executive Review per year, board attendance by agreement	€4,500/mth	€6,250/mth
Chair's Counsel	A chair or owner who wants John personally, continuously	Unlimited briefs within reason, all seven domains, direct access, board and ARC attendance	€7,500/mth	€9,750/mth

Minimum twelve months. Quarterly in advance. Reviewed annually.

Why this tier matters more than any other. It removes the sell. Line one has to win a new client every time. A retained seat compounds, it is predictable, and it is what makes Meridian a business rather than a series of engagements. ***Three Intelligence Partner clients at list is €225,000 a year before a single brief is sold.*** That is the number to aim at.

5 AI EQUITY STRUCTURING — BESPOKE, FEE PLUS EQUITY

AI capability contributed for equity, structured so it survives a funding round.

What it answers. How do we contribute AI capability into a business in exchange for a shareholding, and how do we structure it so a Series A investor accepts it rather than unwinding it.

This is Manager 7 and it is the line almost nobody else is offering. Barber Republic is arguably the first live instance: milestone-based sweat equity for build work, alongside an investor's cash on a convertible, with the two carefully kept distinct.

Commercial shape. A structuring fee at Transaction Intelligence rates, plus an equity participation negotiated case by case. Slowest to convert and hardest to sell cold, which is why it is line five and not line one. But it is the line that turns Meridian from a fee business into an asset business, and every engagement in it compounds.

FUNDING OFFSETS — THE ENTRY ROUTE WORTH BUILDING

Enterprise Ireland Innovation Voucher, up to €5,000. At €4,950 list, a Decision Brief is designed to sit exactly inside a single Innovation Voucher. That is a client acquiring a full Meridian brief at close to no net cost, which is the strongest possible first engagement.

ACTION, worth doing this week: confirm whether Meridian is, or can become, an Enterprise Ireland registered knowledge provider. Innovation Vouchers can only be redeemed against registered providers. If Meridian can register, this price point becomes a genuine market entry weapon.

UNVERIFIED until checked. Do not put it in front of a client before it is confirmed.

Skillnet Ireland. Applies to training-shaped delivery. Relevant to the Ambrion products rather than to Meridian's decision work, and it should follow those products across.

WHAT COMES OFF THE MERIDIAN PRICE LIST

The current sheet sells three products, all of them AI services: AI in Plain English (€6,500), AI Governance Readiness Assessment (€12,000), AI Readiness Accelerator (€18,000).

All three move to Ambrion. Ambrion's live campaign is tiered done-for-you EU AI Act compliance for Irish SMEs. A readiness assessment is not adjacent to that, it is a tier of it. AI in Plain English is the natural top-of-funnel for the Smacht network of roughly 300 SMEs and for the accountant and solicitor referral channel. The Accelerator is the delivery tier. They are good products sitting under the wrong brand, with a ready-built route to market waiting for them under the right one.

Meridian keeps the AI domain in the engine, where a decision touches it. **Meridian stops selling AI.**

HOW TO PRESENT PRICE — FIVE RULES

- 1. Never lead with the number. Lead with the decision.** “What is the decision worth to you if you get it right, and what does it cost you if you get it wrong?” The price answers itself after that.
- 2. Give three options, not one.** Decision Brief, Executive Review, Intelligence Partner. Buyers given one option decide whether to buy. Buyers given three decide which to buy.
- 3. Anchor high, then place.** Mention the mid-tier consultancy comparison of €40,000 to €100,000 over six to twelve weeks before naming your own figure. Every number after that sounds reasonable.
- 4. Hold the price. Move the scope.** If a client cannot reach €12,950, they do not get a discounted Review. They get a Decision Brief at €4,950. Discounting the product teaches the market the price was invented. Reducing the scope teaches them it was real.
- 5. Say no to the ones that are too small.** A client with a €50,000 decision is not a Meridian client yet. Telling them so is worth more in reputation than the fee is in cash, and it is the single most credible thing a new practice can do.

THE FIRST NINETY DAYS — A REALISTIC REVENUE PICTURE

Deliberately conservative, founding rates, and assuming Ambrion's compliance campaign remains the priority claim on John's time.

	Month 1	Month 2	Month 3
Decision Briefs	2	3	3
Executive Reviews	0	1	1
Intelligence Partner	0	1 (Board Seat)	2
Revenue	€7,500	€22,250	€25,750

*Roughly **€55,000 across the first quarter** at founding rates, with two retained clients carrying into the next one. A real business, built on a product set already proven nine times, and it does not require Meridian to be anyone's primary vehicle.*

THE SIX ACTIONS

- 1. Replace the current pricing sheet.** The three AI products move to Ambrion. The five products above go live.
- 2. Rename “friends rate” to “founding client rate.”** First ten clients, ends 31 December 2026.
- 3. Check the Enterprise Ireland registered knowledge provider position this week.** It decides whether the Innovation Voucher route is real.
- 4. Convert United Hardware to a named Intelligence Partner tier.** It is already this relationship. It is simply not priced as one.
- 5. Run Primeline, Vinny Leonard and DSB Accountants as the first three founding-rate Decision Briefs.** Treat DSB as a double play: a Meridian client and an Ambrion referral partner in one conversation.
- 6. Decide the success-element policy on Transaction Intelligence** before the first deal above €2m, not during it.

Meridian Intelligence · Products and pricing · 5 August 2026 · Private and confidential. Every product shape is drawn from work already delivered and filed in the Meridian repository. Prices are recommendations for John's decision, not yet set. The Enterprise Ireland Innovation Voucher route is UNVERIFIED pending confirmation of registered knowledge provider status. Velocity comparison pricing verified from the EDelia proposal, June 2026.